TECHNOLOGY EVOLVING CARDIAC SURGERIES TO BECOME SAFER, FASTER AND PAIN-FREE FOR THE PATIENT

Feted for his extraordinary skills in the domain of cardiac sciences and interventions, Dr Rajneesh Malhotra, has over 31 years of outstanding experience and credentials. An alumni of King George's Medical College, Lucknow, from where he did his M.B.B.S. & M.S (General Surgery), the academically brilliant surgeon went on to do MCh from Institute of Cardiology, G.S.V.M. Medical College, Kanpur. He is member on several national and international bodies and societies in Cardiology and is often sought after to address august medical gatherings across India and the world-over in the speciality of heart interventions. He talks about the focus of cardiologists on patient management, a recent trend that has gained momentum.

What has been the impact of advancements in cardiac sciences and technology on management of heart diseases?

In the last decade, we have witnessed ground-breaking transformation in healthcare including cardiac care. These developments aided by AI technology are very exciting for cardiac Surgeons to improve and cure heart ailments in all its dimensions as well as plan customised and targeted treatments from diagnostics reports now being more precise and dependable. Advancements have enabled cardiac Surgeon to focus on better management of the patients to extend their life span from time-to-time with the combination of interventions and advanced drugs to lead a quality life. For doctors treating heart patients with the latest methodologies have given outcomes that have been very satisfying as they not only reduce morbidity and mortality significantly, but enable the patients fend for themselves in every possible manner.



Heart attacks are the most prevalent in the population. What are the treatments available for such patients?

Heart attacks occur when the arteries of the heart get blocked due to excess cholesterol or calcification. The use of advance treatments are now becoming increasingly common in India, particularly in treating heart attacks and artery disease. For Coronary Artery Disease stents (CABG), Minimally Invasive and Robotic Cardiac Surgeries provide the possible solutions. We have more precise, faster and safer ways to perform Coronary Artery Bypass (CABG) with Robotic assistance and minimally invasive surgeries. Along with medications,



monitoring and check-ups, heart patients can lead a normal life by modifying their lifestyle such as adhering to heart-healthy diet, do regular exercise and quit smoking, which are crucial for preventing future heart attacks.

How are doctors managing cholesterol in the patients and the latest treatment available for it?

Low density of lipo protein (LDL) or Bad Cholesterol is one of the main culprits to cause Plaque formation leading to blockage in Coronary Arteries and Heat Attacks. LDL can be controlled with statins to reduce the risk of heart attacks but many patients are intolerant or resistant to statins, in such cases now new ground breaking injectable drugs are available